

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader moving closer to the model — AI shipped into production, not demoed

CONTACT

LOCATION

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years and led design teams for more than a decade of that, and I spent the last year moving closer to the model. At Bibel TV that means a support copilot live in production, an AI fundraising system I built solo end to end, and prototypes running on real APIs that engineering ships from. Before that, the prompt-to-database onboarding model I designed for Ninox's founders, design leadership at ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — a Microsoft Copilot skill I designed and scoped, not a custom build. It drafts viewer letters, emails and social messages in the support handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. Restricted topics are enforced in the output. The draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, so escalation is an output in its own right and not a fallback, and every send decision stays human.
- Quality agreed before the prompt was tuned — the support team spelled out what counts as a good draft first. Rollout was fully optional: a week of self-testing, then one-to-one sessions, then team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Validation was qualitative observation, not a scored golden set. Complex letters now take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and sceptics converted after their hardest case.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysed past letters against their performance for the seasonality and style patterns that separate the strong from the weak, encoded that into a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before it generates, built the prototype, then shipped a Claude skill producing follow-up content across in-app notifications, web banners and video scripts.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and engineering ships from that code. Around 70% of AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours, and web-first assumptions got corrected on the Android prototype before production work started.
- Design system as an API — DTG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Android and Figma are live, iOS and web endpoints defined. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- App redesign — leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries. The hard constraints here were legal, not technical.
- Customer-service workflow, designed and initiated — shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified for parish teams handling enquiries and requests. Only the booking module went live before the M&A centralisation.
- Booking module, product and design both — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, coordinating 20+ cemeteries at the launch customer. 1 direct report.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, after my employment there) — the AI generates a working schema from a description, and it renders into the real data-model editor rather than a chat preview. Chat and direct manipulation sit side by side, because the first schema is almost always wrong and typing corrections into a chat log does not scale. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — design established as a function co-equal with product and engineering. Hired two, let two go.
- Coaching a peer in craft — coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship, and set up shared design-system governance across 4 designers and engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the shared service centre. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue, and I worked with IT on the service-desk and ITSM implementation.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the programme.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Research inside regulated industries — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach people working inside banks and insurers. The design system was co-built: UX defined component behaviour and specs, UI executed the visual system.
- Design as a business partner — secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

AI Chops — Model Behaviour and Agent Workflows

Agent workflows in production: handbook loaded as context, restricted topics enforced in the output, escalation as an output in its own right, the send decision always human · Prompt architecture with clarifying-question loops before generation · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Quality targets agreed with the people who use the output, before prompt tuning · Structured rollout and qualitative validation

Agentic Engineering and AI-Product Craft

Claude Code, Claude Projects, Claude skills · Microsoft Copilot · Prototypes running on real APIs that engineering ships from · Around 70% of AI-generated code lands; iteration days to hours · Web-first assumptions caught on the Android prototype before production · AI alt-text shipped under GDPR-plus data-protection law

Design Leadership and Coaching Senior ICs

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Hiring and performance calls in both directions · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, OKLCH · Live sync to Android and Figma, iOS and web endpoints defined · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

Research, Experimentation and Distributed Teams

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas inside regulated institutions · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2